MERIDIAN FORGE / WEEK 03 / ANALYST DOCUMENT

Stakeholder Map

Stakeholder Analysis · Revision 156

Proposed QA Control Review / participation and decision rights

PEOPLE	RELATIONSHIPS	NEXT CONVERSATIONS
Who is affected?	Who contributes and decides?	What needs confirmation?

1. People and roles

QA and night-shift operators

QA and night-shift operators at Meridian Forge are directly affected by the proposed review and operational changes. Their day-to-day work involves running quality assurance and technical operations, and they need a clear participation picture as well as proper channels to voice their practical workflow requirements before the review moves forward. While they hold direct operational influence through their hands-on feedback, they lack overarching budgetary or project approval authority. Furthermore, Nia’s account must be kept distinct and separated from the accounts of other night-shift operators who have not yet been formally interviewed. (Source: W03-S01)

Engineering

Elias contributes by explaining command and scheduler records, reviewing technical interpretations, and advising on technical feasibility. He needs read-only exports with source details and a preliminary access discussion with the record custodian. His limits include being unable to trace the repeated command's origin or authorize spending. Crucially, Elias's specialized technical expertise does not grant him approval authority or the power to authorize budget spending or project restarts.(Source: W03-S02)

Operations

Mara Ilyan serves as the Production Operations Manager, coordinating by carrying the learner's Week 2 recommendation into review to determine whether to proceed, revise, defer, or decline. Her priorities include establishing a clear decision route, creating a usable summary of who must be consulted, confirming missing participants and decision rights before gathering detailed requirements, and proposing a single daytime meeting. She can seek and confirm stakeholder contacts, but she cannot approve the

project or authorize spending, as those actions require another designated decision-maker. (Source: W03-S04)

Sponsor and record custodian

Record Custodian Role:Known Responsibility: Designated to manage records within the proposed QA Control Review alongside QA, Engineering, and Operations.
Missing Named Contact: The entry has no named contact, and the supplied extract contains no confirmation that anyone has accepted this responsibility.
Authority Needing Confirmation: It must be confirmed who holds ownership and decision authority for the records, as a blank entry or meeting list presence does not prove consent or availability.

Authorizing Sponsor Role:Known Responsibility: Responsible for receiving recommendations routed from Operations and authorizing proposed work within the organization's approval process.
Missing Named Contact: The entry fails to identify the specific individual holding the sponsor role.
Authority Needing Confirmation: Specific decision limits and a signed approval need formal confirmation, as the current packet contains neither. (Source: W03-S03)

2. Relationships and next steps

Competing needs and tradeoff

Mara Ilyan proposes a single daytime meeting to establish a clear decision route and consultation summary, whereas Nia Voss requests that a night-shift operator participate in checking the workflow around shift duties. Currently, no agreement on meeting timing has been recorded between these competing preferences. To hear both perspectives without falsely claiming an official agreement, an analyst can structure a flexible consultation approach such as pairing the daytime review with a separate, asynchronous check-in or brief interview tailored to the night-shift operator's schedule,and document both accounts side-by-side.

Consultation plan

QA (Nia Voss & Night-Shift Operator):
Whom to consult: Nia Voss, Night QA Supervisor, and a to-be-selected night-shift operator.
Question: How does the proposed record-checking workflow fit into actual night-shift QA work and operating duties?
Method: A combination of a structured review session for Nia and an asynchronous or shift-aligned check-in for the night-shift operator.
When: Before finalizing workflow requirements or moving forward with the review plan.

Engineering (Elias Chen):
Whom to consult: Elias Chen, Robotics Systems Engineer.
Question: What technical interpretations can be drawn from available command and scheduler records,

and what are the read-only export requirements?
Method: A technical access discussion involving Elias and the record custodian.
When: Prior to promising any project delivery dates.

Operations (Mara Ilyan):
Whom to consult: Mara Ilyan, Production Operations Manager.
Question: How should the consultation path, decision routes, and participant roles be organized for the review process?
Method: A formal coordination review session (accommodating both daytime preferences and night-shift constraints).
When: Early in the planning phase to confirm decision rights and participant roles before gathering detailed requirements.

Missing Contacts (Record Custodian & Authorizing Sponsor):
Whom to consult: The designated record custodian and the organizational authorizing sponsor.
Question: Who formally accepts record custody responsibilities, and who holds the authorization limits and spending approval for the project?
Method: Formal inquiry and documentation review to track down contact confirmation.
When: Immediately, as a prerequisite before any detailed requirements or project progression can occur.

Why a Person with Little Formal Authority Needs a Voice:Individuals with minimal formal decision-making or spending authority such as night-shift operators or specialized technical staff often hold critical operational insights, day-to-day context, and exception-recording duties. Omitting their perspectives risks introducing undetected operational flaws, impractical workflows, or unworkable technical constraints that higher-level approvals cannot fix on their own.

Missing voices and validation

Unresolved Question 1:
Record Custodian Contact and AcceptanceQuestion: Who is the specific individual assigned as the record custodian, and have they formally accepted responsibility for managing the read-only exports and access discussions?
Who Should Seek Confirmation: Mara Ilyan (Production Operations Manager) or the analyst, as part of confirming missing participants and decision rights before gathering detailed requirements.
How to Record the Answer: Document the confirmed name, date of contact, and a clear statement of acceptance or refusal in the stakeholder register. Silence or a blank entry will be explicitly recorded as "unconfirmed/pending" rather than interpreted as consent.

Unresolved Question 2:
Authorizing Sponsor Identity and Spending LimitsQuestion: Who holds the authorizing sponsor role for the organization, what are their specific financial decision limits, and will they provide a signed approval?
Who Should Seek Confirmation: Mara Ilyan, leveraging her role in routing recommendations through the organization's approval process.

> How to Record the Answer: Record the sponsor's name, title, explicit budget approval threshold, and formal sign-off status in the project documentation. Unconfirmed or missing sponsor details will be logged as an open risk item, ensuring that lack of response is never treated as implied budget authorization.

> **Next step toward requirements**
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> What Must Be Confirmed Before Requirements Interviews:
> Missing participant contacts and explicit decision rights must be confirmed specifically identifying the designated record custodian, the authorizing sponsor, and a participating night-shift operator.
> Scheduling and availability agreements must be settled to resolve the tension between daytime reviews and night-shift duties.
> Formal consent and acceptance of responsibilities must be established, ensuring that blank entries, missing names, or silence are not mistaken for approval or participation.
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> How the Stakeholder Map Helps Invite the Right People Without Authorizing the Project:
> The map cleanly categorizes stakeholders by their distinct functions distinguishing between those doing the work, those affected by it, those offering specialist technical advice, and the roles holding record custody or financial approval.
> By explicitly outlining these roles and capturing unresolved gaps, the map serves as an operational directory and consultation guide rather than a funding or restart approval. It ensures invitations are sent based on verified responsibilities and necessary perspectives such as combining Nia's daytime framework with night-shift operator input and Elias's technical guidance, while explicitly keeping project startup, budget spending, and final authorization on hold until the proper sponsor signs off.

3. Book evidence connection

> **Book form connection**
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> The questions and tools improved the plan by changing how we talk to people. Instead of just treating workers like names on a checklist, the identity-building questions ask them about their actual daily tasks and limits. This helps us understand what they really do every day so we do not miss important details.

> **Book evidence filename**
>
> Anyanwu_Nzubechi_CIT140_Week03_Book_Form.pdf

Case sources

W03-S01 · QA participation note — Nia Voss · Night QA Supervisor

W03-S02 · Engineering participation note — Elias Chen · Robotics Systems Engineer

W03-S03 · Participation and authority register — QA records workstation · Read-only planning extract

W03-S04 · Operations consultation request — Mara Ilyan · Production Operations Manager

The book evidence file is supplied separately; this report does not embed or upload it. Fictional teaching case. This map does not establish consent, authorize spending or permit operation of equipment. A structurally complete report is not a grade.